Stay Safe Online

1. **Use strong, unique passwords**
    - Use at least 10–12 characters with a mix of letters, numbers, and symbols.
    - Don't reuse the same password for college portal, email, and social media.
2. **Enable two-factor authentication (2FA)**
    - Turn on 2FA for your email, social media, banking, and UPI apps.
    - Prefer app-based OTP (like authenticator apps) over SMS when possible.
3. **Think before you click links**
    - Don't click on suspicious links sent on WhatsApp, Telegram, Instagram DMs, or email, especially if they promise gifts, jobs, or "KYC update".
    - Always check the URL carefully; fake sites often look very similar to real ones.
4. **Verify unknown contacts and offers**
    - If someone messages you about internships, part-time jobs, or "money doubling" schemes, verify through official websites or phone numbers.
    - Never share personal documents (Aadhaar, PAN, college ID) with unknown people online.
5. **Financial/UPI safety: never share OTP, UPI PIN, or screen-share**
    - Bank officials, UPI apps, and customer care will **never** ask for your OTP, UPI PIN, or to install screen-sharing apps (AnyDesk, TeamViewer, etc.).
    - If someone asks for these in the name of refund/prize/offer, disconnect immediately.
6. **Financial/UPI safety: double-check payment requests and QR codes**
    - When scanning a QR code or accepting a collect request, confirm the receiver's name and amount before entering your UPI PIN.
    - Remember: entering your UPI PIN always means money is going **out** of your account, not coming in.
7. **Protect your devices and data**
    - Keep your phone and laptop locked with PIN, fingerprint, or password.

- Update your OS and apps regularly, and avoid downloading cracked software or modded APKs.

8. **Control what you share online**
    - Avoid posting real-time location (hostel, PG, college hangout spots) publicly.
    - Be careful with personal photos, timetables, and contact details on open profiles.
9. **Be cautious with public Wi-Fi**
    - Avoid using public Wi-Fi for banking, UPI transactions, or accessing important accounts.
    - If you must, use a VPN and log out after use.
10. **Know how and where to report**
    - If you face online fraud, cyberbullying, blackmail, or UPI/financial scams, act quickly:
        - **National Cyber Crime Portal**: https://www.cybercrime.gov.in
        - **Cybercrime Helpline**: **1930** (especially for online financial fraud/UPI scams)
    - Also inform your bank immediately for transaction blocking, and keep screenshots/chat logs as evidence.